# Lan E. Luo

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## Academic Appointment

Yale School of Management, Yale University
Assistant Professor of Marketing — July 2026–Present

## Education

Columbia University
Ph.D. Marketing — 2026
*Committee: Olivier Toubia, Oded Netzer, Asim Ansari, Andrey Simonov, Ryan Dew*
M.Phil. Marketing — 2024

Yale University
B.A. Economics; B.A. Statistics & Data Science (Honors) — 2020

## Research Interests

**Substantive**: Data-Driven Design, User-Generated Content, Digital Advertising, Social Issues
**Methodological**: Deep Generative Modeling, Interpretable Machine Learning, Applied Econometrics, Causal Inference, Probabilistic Machine Learning

## Journal Publications

Frontiers: Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation
**Lan E. Luo** and Olivier Toubia
*Marketing Science, 2026*

Probabilistic Machine Learning: New Frontiers for Modeling Consumers and their Choices
Ryan Dew, Nicolas Padilla, **Lan E. Luo**, Shin Oblander, Asim Ansari, Khaled Boughanmi, Michael Braun, Fred Feinberg, Jia Liu, Thomas Otter, Longxiu Tian, Yixin Wang, and Mingzhang Yin
*International Journal of Research in Marketing, 2026*

Public attitudes value interpretability but prioritize accuracy in Artificial Intelligence
Anne-Marie Nussberger, **Lan Luo**, L. Elisa Celis, and Molly J. Crockett
*Nature Communications, 2022*

## Working Papers

How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design
**Lan E. Luo**
*Draft available upon request*

## Works in Progress *(* indicates equal authorship)*

Theory-Guided AI Conversations as Flexible Choice Architecture: Evidence from Retirement Benefit Claiming
Daniel Russman*, **Lan E. Luo***, Alisa Wu*, and Eric J. Johnson

Sparse Autoencoders Reveal (and Generate) the Drivers of Online Sharing
Reed Orchinik*, **Lan E. Luo***

How Livestreaming Chats Engage Consumers
**Lan E. Luo***, Eric S. Park*

Causality in Conversations
Ryan Dew*, Yu Ding*, **Lan E. Luo***

AI-Powered Conjoint Analysis
Ryan Dew, **Lan E. Luo**

## Invited Seminar Talks *(includes scheduled talks)*

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| Shidler College of Business, University of Hawaii at Manoa | May 2027 |
| Booth School of Business, University of Chicago | February 2027 |
| Amazon Science Seminar | November 2026 |
| SC Johnson Graduate School of Management, Cornell University | November 2026 |
| Virtual Quantitative Marketing Seminar | October 2026 |
| Technical University of Munich, GenAI Lab | January 2026 |
| The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania | October 2025 |
| C. T. Bauer College of Business, University of Houston | October 2025 |
| Yale School of Management | October 2025 |
| Tuck School of Business, Dartmouth College | October 2025 |
| Lee Kong Chian School of Business, Singapore Management University | September 2025 |
| NUS Business School, National University of Singapore | September 2025 |
| Institut Européen d'Administration des Affaires (INSEAD) | September 2025 |
| Sauder School of Business, University of British Columbia | September 2025 |
| McCombs School of Business, University of Texas at Austin | August 2025 |

## Conference & Workshop Presentations

Thirteenth Triennial Choice Symposium, University of Colorado Boulder, Vail, Colorado — August 2026
- *Seeing Choice: Visual Cues and Decision-Making*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, Nova School of Business and Economics, Carcavelos, Portugal — June 2026
- *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

Conference on Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, and Business Analytics, Columbia University, New York — December 2025
- *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

GenAI in Marketing & Advertising Roundtable, Meta, New York November 2025
- *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, University of Georgia, Washington, D.C. June 2025
- *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, UNSW Sydney, Australia June 2024
- *Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation*

Symposium on Artificial Intelligence in Marketing, University of Wisconsin–Madison May 2024
- *Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation*

Twelfth Triennial Choice Symposium, Institut Européen d'Administration des Affaires (INSEAD), Fontainebleau, France August 2023
- *Probabilistic Machine Learning for Scalable, Flexible, and Interpretable Models of Choice*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, University of Miami, Florida June 2023
- *Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation*

## Awards & Honors

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| Finalist, American Statistical Association's Marketing Dissertation Award | 2026 |
| AMA-Sheth Foundation Doctoral Consortium Fellow | 2025 |
| Columbia Experimental Laboratory in the Social Sciences Travel Grant | 2024 |
| W. Edwards Deming Center Doctoral Fellowship | 2023 |
| Bernstein Center for Leadership and Ethics Doctoral Research Grant | 2022 |
| Don Lehmann Scholar Award | 2020 |
| Yale Hartigan Undergraduate Senior Thesis Prize for Statistics & Data Science | 2020 |
| Richter Summer Fellowship Research Award | 2019 |
| Herb Scarf Fellowship Research Award in Economics | 2018 |
| Tobin Research Award in Economics | 2018 |

## Teaching Experience

**Instructor** *Yale School of Management*

Generative AI and Social Media (MGT 575, MBA) Spring 2027

## Academic Service *(includes scheduled service)*

**Conference Discussant**

- Discussant, "Platforms and Digital Economy" session, Allied Social Science Associations (ASSA) Annual Meeting, American Economic Association, January 2027

**Conference Session Organization**

– Session Co-Organizer, "Generative AI for Marketing Measurement, Experimentation, and Design," ISMS Marketing Science Conference, June 2026

## Industry Experience

Analysis Group, *Summer Analyst Intern* 2019

## Skills

**Languages**: English (native); Mandarin, French (proficient); Korean, Japanese (basic)
**Programming**: Python, R (fluent); Stata, Stan, Mathematica, Java, SQL (familiar)